

Preston Carey Leslie

843.694.6959 | prestoncarey90@gmail.com | prestoncarey90.github.io/portfolio/ | linkedin.com/in/preston-leslie/

Dear University Director for Global Education and Initiatives and Selection Committee,

As an MS Graduate in Quantitative Methods & Modeling from Baruch College combined with 15 years of complex operational leadership, I am writing to express my interest in the Global Systems Associate position within the Office of Academic Affairs. My career specializes in the exact domain this role demands: bridging the gap between sophisticated data architecture and real-world institutional workflows. As a proud CUNY alumnus, I am deeply committed to applying my systems-scientific background to protect and scale CUNY's mission of access, affordability, and global upward mobility.

My quantitative training at Baruch directly equips me to handle the data infrastructure required for this role. I have an advanced command of data manipulation, including building multi-source data models using Microsoft Office (Advanced Excel and Power Queries) and developing automated data ingestion applications in Python. Because I am fluent in pipeline engineering, cloud data transformation (dbt), and advanced analytics platforms like Alteryx, I am fully prepared to readily translate my skills into CUNY's Power BI and Power Automate frameworks. Furthermore, my demonstrated ability to leverage generative AI productivity tools ensures I can rapidly automate administrative reporting pipelines and eliminate processing friction from day one.

What truly distinguishes my candidacy, however, is my extensive background navigating high-stakes data environments and structural risk management. I have lived the reality of large-scale software transitions, such as enterprise Electronic Health Record migrations, where I audited system logic, verified source-to-destination field mapping, and managed database data quality. I understand intuitively that database integrity and global risk awareness fail when workflows are built on management perception rather than frontline reality. Whether managing system access and workflow permissions within platforms like CUNYfirst and EAB Navigate, or tracking risk indices across international boundaries, I bring the mature communication skills required to coordinate consistent messaging across diverse campus constituent networks.

This position perfectly captures the amalgamation of my skills: analytical rigor, technical data literacy, and a veteran advocate's maturity. Finally, as a former elected 1199SEIU Union Delegate who has partnered directly with executive administrative leadership to navigate complex collective bargaining agreements, I understand and deeply respect the institutional and labor fabric that keeps CUNY running. I am highly adept at organizing hybrid and remote environments to align diverse teams, and I am eager to bring this operational stability to CUNY Central Office.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and continued dedication to public higher education. I look forward to discussing how my operational background and quantitative training can immediately enhance your global education initiatives.

Sincerely,

Preston Carey Leslie

